cognition and feeling are joined by volition. For in that case we are confronted by the ancient dilemma of freedom of the will *versus* the law of causality. This problem holds a certain significance for ethics, too, and its discussion will be our immediate next step.

Is the will free, or is it causally determined? In order to be able to answer this question, first of all we must examine the methods which can be utilized for the study of the laws and regularity of volitional processes.

In this connection an important point must first be observed: In order to gain a correct insight into the regular course of a process, one must take every precaution lest the process be influenced by the method of observation used. Thus, for instance, when trying to ascertain the temperature of a body, we must not use any thermometer, the introduction of which would cause a change in the temperature under examination; similarly, in the microscopic observation of the processes taking place in a living cell, we must not employ illumination which might interfere with the normal course of those processes. All that holds true for physical and biological processes, applies naturally to the same extent to mental states and processes, too. It is one of the most elementary principles of experimental psychology that an observation may produce a totally false finding if the subject knows, or even suspects that he is being observed. For this reason, under certain circumstances, the observation itself will constitute a serious source of error.

Applying the above principle to the problem now before us, the most basic and elementary requirement which a scientifically perfect observation of the regular course of a volitional impulse must fulfill, is that it should not affect or influence that impulse. The automatic consequence of this requirement is that the choice of the acceptable viewpoint of the observation must, necessarily, be restricted. Namely, since the observation itself is no less a mental process than the volitional impulse which is to be observed, the observation may, under certain circumstances, influence the course of the volitional impulse, and thus distort the final finding. The only time when there is no reason to fear such interference is when you observe the will of another person without his knowledge, or when another person observes your will without your knowledge. On the other hand, this source of error will always be operative whenever you attempt to observe your own will. For in that case the mental process of the observation coincides in your unified self-consciousness with the mental process of the volitional impulse. Therefore, it is inadmissible to observe one’s own will from the viewpoint of one’s own Ego—and I am referring to the present as well as the future act of will, for the latter is co-determined by the present will, too. On the other hand, there is nothing to preclude a scientific observation of a volitional impulse of one’s own past Ego. For past mental processes are not affected by a later analysis. In order to express this situation, I shall from now on make a distinction